VEDICSLOKAS · STUDY NOTES

Srimad Bhagavad Gita

Chapter 1 – Arjuna Vishada Yoga

Slokas 1–12 · English
English transliteration and meaning

Sloka 1

Sanskrit transliteration

Dhritarashtra Uvacha: Dharmakshetre Kurukshetre Samaveta Yuyutsavah, Mamakah Pandavashchaiva Kimakurvata Sanjaya.

English meaning

King Dhritarashtra asked: O Sanjaya, after gathering on the holy land of Kurukshetra, eager to fight, what did my sons and the sons of Pandu do?

Sloka 2

Sanskrit transliteration

Sanjaya Uvacha: Drishtva Tu Pandavanikam Vyudham Duryodhanastada, Acharyam Upasangamya Raja Vachanam Abravit.

English meaning

Sanjaya said: Seeing the army of the Pandavas arranged in battle formation, King Duryodhana approached his teacher, Dronacharya, and spoke these words.

Sloka 3

Sanskrit transliteration

Pashyaitam Panduputranam Acharya Mahatim Chamum, Vyudham Drupadaputrena Tava Shishyena Dhimata.

English meaning

O teacher, look at this mighty army of the sons of Pandu, arranged in battle formation by your intelligent disciple, the son of Drupada.

Sloka 4

Sanskrit transliteration

Atra Shura Maheshvasa Bhimarjunasama Yudhi, Yuyudhano Viratashcha Drupadashcha Maharathah.

English meaning

Here are mighty warriors and great archers who are equal in battle to Bhima and Arjuna, including Yuyudhana, Virata, and the great chariot warrior Drupada.

Sloka 5

Sanskrit transliteration

Dhrishtaketush Chekitanah Kashirajashcha Viryavan, Purujit Kuntibhojashcha Shaibyashcha Narapungavah.

English meaning

There are Dhrishtaketu, Chekitana, the valiant King of Kashi, Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Shaibya, the finest among men.

Sloka 6

Sanskrit transliteration

Yudhamanyushcha Vikranta Uttamaujashcha Viryavan, Saubhadro Draupadeyashcha Sarva Eva Maharathah.

English meaning

There are the courageous Yudhamanyu, the valiant Uttamaujas, Abhimanyu, the son of Subhadra, and the sons of Draupadi. All of them are great warriors.

Sloka 7

Sanskrit transliteration

Asmakam Tu Vishishta Ye Tannibodha Dvijottama, Nayaka Mama Sainyasya Samjnartham Tanbravimi Te.

English meaning

O best among the Brahmins, now listen to the distinguished leaders of our army. I shall name them for your information.

Sloka 8

Sanskrit transliteration

Bhavan Bhishmashcha Karnashcha Kripashcha Samitinjayah, Ashvatthama Vikarnashcha Saumadattistathaiva Cha.

English meaning

You yourself, Bhishma, Karna, Kripacharya, who is victorious in battle, Ashvatthama, Vikarna, and Bhurishrava, the son of Somadatta, are among our warriors.

Sloka 9

Sanskrit transliteration

Anye Cha Bahavah Shura Madarthe Tyaktajivitah, Nanashastrapraharanah Sarve Yuddhavisharadah.

English meaning

There are many other brave warriors who are prepared to sacrifice their lives for my sake. They are equipped with various weapons and are skilled in the art of warfare.

Sloka 10

Sanskrit transliteration

Aparyaptam Tadasmakam Balam Bhishmabhirakshitam, Paryaptam Tvidam Etesham Balam Bhimabhirakshitam.

English meaning

Our army, protected by Bhishma, is immeasurable, while the army of the Pandavas, protected by Bhima, appears limited. Note: commentators interpret the key Sanskrit words in this verse differently.

Sloka 11

Sanskrit transliteration

Ayaneshu Cha Sarveshu Yathabhagamavasthitah, Bhishmamevabhirakshantu Bhavantah Sarva Eva Hi.

English meaning

Therefore, all of you, stationed in your respective positions at the entrances and strategic points, must protect Bhishma from every side.

Sloka 12

Sanskrit transliteration

Tasya Sanjanayan Harsham Kuruvriddhah Pitamahah, Simhanadam Vinadyocchaih Shankham Dadhmau Pratapavan.

English meaning

To encourage Duryodhana, the mighty and venerable grandsire Bhishma, the eldest of the Kuru dynasty, roared like a lion and blew his conch loudly.

Chapter summary

These verses introduce the battlefield of Kurukshetra, where the Kauravas and Pandavas stand ready for war. Dhritarashtra asks Sanjaya what is happening. Duryodhana surveys the Pandava army, names key warriors in his own army, instructs his commanders to protect Bhishma, and Bhishma blows his conch to encourage the troops.